ELLIE THOMPSON

BRAND MANAGER · MARKETING DIRECTOR · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

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Brand leader with seven years growing consumer food brands from the inside out, and the person behind the reinvention of a 30-year-old company into Maeve Chocolate: a brand now winning national design awards and selling out in record time. Psychology grad with a serious design habit, who pairs consumer insight with a sharp eye, sells the vision internally, directs world-class creative partners, and turns concepts into award-winning, record-breaking products.

110%	18%	36 hrs	4	82%	37%
YOY ECOMMERCE GROWTH POST-REBRAND	OVERALL GROWTH	FASTEST SELLOUT IN COMPANY HISTORY	NATIONAL DESIGN AWARDS: 3 DIELINE, 1 WEBBY	INSTAGRAM GROWTH, 22K TO 40K	EMAIL GROWTH, 40K TO 55K

EXPERIENCE

Seattle Chocolate Company · Maeve Chocolate & jcoco

SEATTLE, WA · MAY 2019 – JUN 2026

Promoted four times in six years, from Sales Operations to Director of Marketing, at a 75-person national confections company.

Director of Marketing

AUG 2025 – JUN 2026

Led all marketing as the department's voice on the executive leadership team, managing a 6-person in-house team plus 10 agency partners across two creative agencies.

Conceived, pitched and licensed an official collaboration with Matt Dinniman's bestselling Dungeon Crawler Carl series. The Virgin Dirty Shirley bar sold out in under 36 hours, became one of the top three bars by volume in the company's 35-year history, and grew into the first playable Dungeon Crawler Carl game, covered by IGN.

Built a national partner strategy on a scrappy budget: rather than pay for dream influencers, went to the stores they shop in. Events and limited-time co-branded products with bookstores, breweries, record stores, vintage stores and museums, including Butterfield Market, Books Are Magic, Su'Juk, Talea Beer Co. and Greenwich Letterpress.

Brought the brand to PAX West, an entirely new audience, where booth demand ran so high the venue stationed permanent security to manage the line.

Secured placement in Pop Up Grocer after years of persistent outreach, expanding the brand's reach with trend-forward retail audiences.

Brand Manager → Senior Brand Manager

APR 2021 – AUG 2025

SIGNATURE PROJECT

The Maeve Rebrand

Pitched and led the complete reinvention of the company's 30-year-old namesake brand, Seattle Chocolate, into Maeve Chocolate over three years: 100+ products, a new name, and a whole world to put them in, the largest initiative in company history. Owned strategy and final decisions across the reimagined products, packaging, the website, merchandising, trade show booths, sales decks, competitive analysis, launch PR and post-launch campaigns, and served as the rebrand's public face on TV, podcasts and in press interviews. The launch carried the brand into national retail for the first time (including Sprouts, with natural grocery ACV up 3 points) and drove every result in the scoreboard above.

SEE THE WORK → MAEVECHOCOLATE.COM

Hired and directed creative agency The Young Jerks after auditioning (and parting with) several others; authored the substance of the brand guidelines and drove detailed creative feedback on every concept for four years.

Partnered with web agency View Source on the Maeve website, a Webby Awards People's Voice Winner for Food & Drink.

Owned five seasonal collections a year end to end: concept, product development, packaging, photography direction and the campaign that took each to market. 50+ limited-time products over four years, plus email, paid social and search, organic social, PR, influencer and brand collaborations.

Creative-directed 15 photoshoots, growing from on-set assistant to owning concepts, shot lists, prop sourcing, contractor and photographer hiring, and on-set direction.

Reimagined the factory tour and flagship store twice, from concept and script to videos, run of show, merchandising and key builds, all designed to transport guests into Maeve's world.

EXPERIENCE, CONTINUED

Brand Manager → Senior Brand Manager, *continued* APR 2021 – AUG 2025

Partnered with the sales team daily, creating hundreds of pieces of collateral over the years: sales decks, catalogs, in-store signage, displays, caddies, shippers, shelf tags and broker mailings.

Represented the brands at major trade shows including the Fancy Food Shows, Natural Products Expo West, Sweets & Snacks Expo, the NW Chocolate Festival and Fine Chocolate Industry Association events.

Grew Instagram from 22K to 40K followers and built the email program that took subscribers from 40K to 55K.

Co-managed sister brand jcoco (craft, culinary-inspired): shaped its 2020 brand refresh, concepted new flavors, and helped create its brand and style guide.

Marketing Coordinator DEC 2019 – APR 2021

Executed digital campaigns, retail collateral and photoshoot production across both brands; earned promotion to Brand Manager within 16 months.

Sales Operations Specialist MAY 2019 – DEC 2019

Joined directly out of college supporting wholesale operations; promoted into marketing within seven months.

BEYOND THE DESK

Origin sourcing & storytelling: traveled to cocoa farms in Ghana, Costa Rica, Nicaragua, Ecuador, Peru and Brazil to meet farmers, shape farmer-support initiatives, and capture content for web, social and advertising; trained hands-on in bean-to-bar chocolate making.

Speaker: industry panels on the climate crisis and its impact on cocoa; guest speaker at the UW Foster School of Business on the Maeve rebrand.

Utility player: at a 75-person company, served as a go-to brainstorm partner for every department and helped lead company-wide strategic planning sessions.

RECOGNITION

★ **Dieline Awards (3)**
2nd place for Maeve's everyday bar line, plus two for seasonal collections. All three conceived and led personally.

★ **Webby Awards**
People's Voice Winner, Food & Drink, for the Maeve website, created with agency View Source.

★ **NEXTY Awards Finalist**
Natural Products Expo West, 2025.

★ **IGN**
Covered the Dungeon Crawler Carl collaboration's playable game, the first of its kind.

EXPERTISE

Brand strategy & positioning · Creative direction · Product development & LTOs · Licensing & partnerships · Integrated campaigns · Agency & vendor management · Consumer psychology · Retail & experiential · Sales enablement · PR & public speaking

FEATURED IN

MSNBC · KING 5 News · Evening Magazine · FOX 13 Seattle · Seattle Magazine · Seattle Refined · Bizwomen · Candy & Snack TODAY · The Sweet Life (NCA) · Transform Magazine · Natural Products Insider · Alaska Airlines in-flight media

Named one of Seattle Business Magazine's Best Companies to Work For during tenure.

EDUCATION

Scripps College · Claremont, CA
BA in Psychology, focus in Media Studies · May 2019

> *"Her innate curiosity, strategic perspective, and genuine kindness make her an inspiring and empathetic leader."*
> KIRSTY ELLISON, VP MARKETING, SEATTLE CHOCOLATE COMPANY